

Zaha Hadid

Visionary Iraqi-British architect Zaha Hadid (b.1950) is celebrated for her use of vast, arching forms and creative use of materials in buildings, product design and furniture. Using unexpected spatial concepts, her buildings incorporate unusual, asymmetrical angles and perspectives, combining tiers, diagonals and fragmented geometry. As the first female recipient of many leading awards, she has blazed a trail for women working in architecture.

Amongst her most notable designs are the Vitra Fire Station (1990–3) in Weil am Rhein, Germany, with concrete planes at dynamic angles that create a sense of tension and urgency; the dramatically curved and angled Bergisel Ski Jump (2002) in Innsbruck; and the Rosenthal Centre for Contemporary Arts in Cincinnati (2003), which has a massive glass curtain wall. The Bridge Pavilion in Zaragoza, Spain (opposite) is a 280-metre (919-ft) covered bridge that formed the centrepiece of the city's hosting of the international Expo 2008.

